

Let's Learn About

- Air Pollution
- Water Pollution
- Noise or Sound Pollution
- Land or Soil Pollution

Warm Up

Observe the logo. What does it mean? Tick the correct answer.

- ☐ Do not throw waste in water bodies.
- ☐ Throw waste in water bodies.



In the previous chapter we learned about the importance of our environment. Now we shall study about the major threats that our environment is facing today. The most important one is pollution. Our environment is getting polluted day-by-day because of three main reasons – industrialisation, urbanisation and population increase. All these factors are caused by human beings. There are four different types of pollution. They are air pollution, water pollution, noise or sound pollution and land or soil pollution.

Air Pollution

Air pollution is caused when harmful gases mix with air. This makes the air dangerous for our health. Breathing in this polluted air can cause harmful diseases. There are many causes of air pollution. It happens mostly due to human activities. The harmful smoke emitted from sources like vehicles, factories and firecrackers pollute the air around us. Increasing traffic, growing cities, rapid economic development and industrialisation are the main reasons of air pollution.



Air pollution

Air pollution can be disastrous because it can harm the ozone layer which protects us from the ultraviolet rays. High level of carbon dioxide causes global warming, which is a very serious matter of concern.

Nature can also be a reason for air pollution. Dust storms in desert areas, smoke from forest fires and ash from volcanic eruptions are some natural phenomena that also cause air pollution. Sometimes the harmful smoke combines with fog to form 'smog' which can cause asthma and other breathing problems.

Not only humans but plants and animals also suffer from air pollution. Plants are not able to make food properly due to air pollution which stunts their growth.

Class Discussion

Discuss in class the side effects of living in large cities with industries and numerous vehicles.

Water Pollution

Water pollution is caused when harmful substances are released in water. Water can be polluted through sewage and waste water, marine dumping, chemical waste, industrial waste and oil pollution. Waste water from houses and sewage water is often dumped into rivers. Industries also dump their harmful wastes and other chemical substances into nearby lakes, rivers and other water bodies. These things cause water contamination. Bathing and washing clothes in rivers also pollute water. Water pollution is a serious threat to both humans and animals. Aquatic animals like fish are not able to live in contaminated water. Plants also suffer from this. In humans, contaminated water can cause dangerous diseases like jaundice, typhoid and cholera.



Water pollution

Learn More

About 80% of urban waste in India ends up in rivers.

Noise or Sound Pollution

Noise pollution is caused by excessive or unpleasant sound. This is another important environment pollution that we are facing now. Noise pollution is faced largely in cities and other densely populated areas. Vehicles are the main reason for noise pollution. The horns from vehicles can be unbearable at times. Human ear can bear only 90 decibels of sound. Anything more than that is harmful for the ears. It can cause stress, irritation and in some cases it can lead to loss of hearing also. Sounds from sources like loudspeakers and firecrackers also cause sound pollution.



Noise pollution

Learn More

Using the Internet, find out three ways to prevent water pollution. Make a dos and don'ts list, and try to follow it.

Land or Soil Pollution

Land pollution refers to the degradation of the Earth's land surface due to the misuse of soil. This happens when harmful substances are released into soil because of activities like poor agricultural practices, mineral exploitation and industrial waste dumping. This results in infertility of soil. Trees cannot grow in such soil and microorganisms cannot survive in it. Soil pollution is a serious threat to the environment.



Land pollution

Let's Recall

- The main reasons behind environmental pollution are industrialisation, urbanisation and population increase.
- The four main types of pollution are air pollution, water pollution, noise pollution and soil pollution.
- Air pollution is caused when harmful gases mix with air.
- Water pollution is caused when harmful substances are released in water.
- Noise pollution is caused by excessive unpleasant sound.
- Land pollution is degradation of the Earth's land surface due to misuse of soil.

Exercises

A Tick the correct answer.

1. Air pollution happens when harmful gases mix with _____.
☐ air ☐ water ☐ soil
2. Which of the following can be caused by noise pollution?
☐ Loss of eyesight ☐ Loss of hearing ☐ Typhoid
3. Which of the following causes jaundice?
☐ Air pollution ☐ Water pollution ☐ Soil pollution
4. Rohit wishes to contribute in reducing air pollution. Which vehicle should he use for going to school?
☐ Car ☐ Bicycle ☐ Scooter

B Write (T) for true and (F) for false sentences.

1. Ozone layer protects us from ultraviolet rays.
2. Typhoid is a disease caused by noise pollution.
3. Land pollution makes the soil infertile.
4. Human ear can bear only 90 decibels of sound.

☐
☐
☐
☐

C Match the columns.

Column A

1. dust storms
2. typhoid
3. poor agricultural practices
4. firecrackers

Column B

- (a) water pollution
- (b) noise pollution
- (c) air pollution
- (d) land pollution

D Answer the following questions.

1. What is air pollution?
2. What is noise pollution? What are its consequences?
3. Explain why land pollution happens.
4. Write a note on water pollution.

E Give reasons.

1. Ozone layer is very important.
2. Water pollution is harmful to both humans and animals.

Activities

Observe and Answer

(Observation, Critical thinking, Memory skills)

Identify the types of pollution in the given pictures.



(a) _____



(b) _____



(c) _____



(d) _____

8

Equatorial Forest Region

Let's Learn About

- Equatorial Forests
- Location of the Democratic Republic of the Congo
- Climate
- Animal Life
- Pygmies
- Present Developments
- Vegetation
- Lifestyle of the People
- Occupation of the People

Warm Up

Does Equator pass from India?

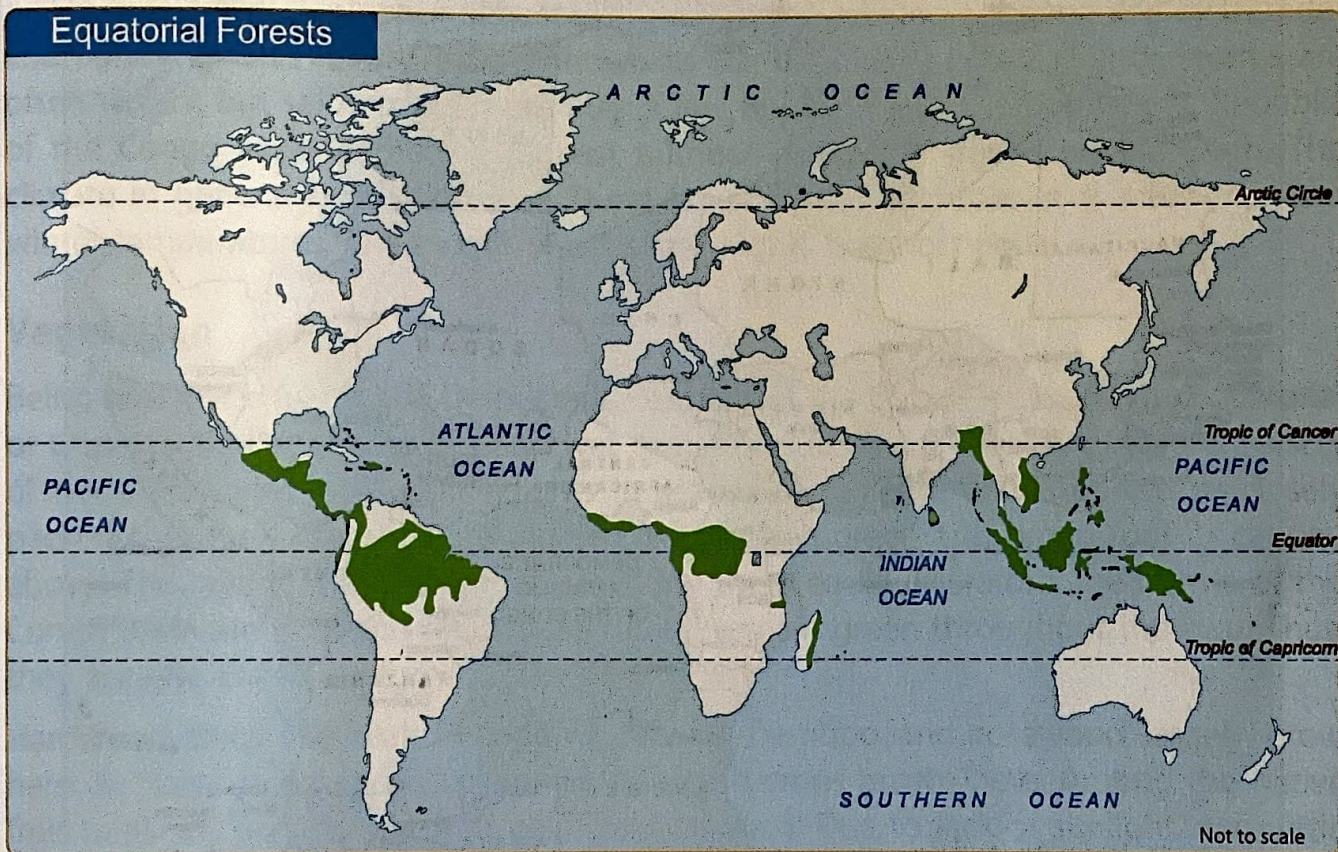
☐

Yes

☐

No

Find out the names of any three countries from which it passes.



Equatorial regions of the world

Equatorial Forests

The equator passes through the continents of South America, Africa and Asia.

Regions located within the Tropical Zone, approximately between 10°N and 10°S latitudes are known as **equatorial regions**. Many countries like Brazil, the Democratic Republic of the Congo (Zaire), Malaysia and Indonesia are located in this region.

Let's learn more about the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) to get a clear idea about how climatic conditions of a region influence the lifestyle of people.

Location of the Democratic Republic of the Congo

The Democratic Republic of the Congo is located deep in the interior of the continent of Africa. It is the second largest country in Africa after Algeria.

The equator passes through the country and hence one-third of it is in the Northern Hemisphere and two-thirds lies in the Southern Hemisphere.

The country is bounded by the Central African Republic and Sudan in the north; Uganda, Rwanda and Burundi in the east; Zambia and Angola in the south; and Congo in the west.



Political map of Africa

River Congo, with its 9 kilometres mouth opening into the Gulf of Guinea, flows through Africa. Ubangi and Kasai are its major tributaries. River Congo along with its tributaries has formed a low-lying area called the Congo Basin. It is surrounded by mountains and plateaus. Most parts of the Democratic Republic of the Congo lie in this basin.

Climate

The climate is hot and humid in the river basin, and cool and dry in the southern highlands. The rainy season lasts from October to May to the south of the equator, and from April to November to the north of the equator. Along the equator, rainfall is fairly regular throughout the year. This part experiences direct rays of the sun. Hence, it has a very hot climate. Due to the heat, there is a great amount of evaporation in its water bodies. This results in the formation of thick clouds. The region hence gets heavy downpour almost every day in the evening accompanied by thunder and lightning. This rainfall is also known as the 4 o'clock rainfall. Thunderstorms are often violent but seldom last more than a few hours. In fact, the Democratic Republic of the Congo experiences the highest number of thunderstorms on the Earth. The climate in general is hot and wet. There is very little difference in the summer and winter temperatures. The length of days and nights is almost equal.

Learn More

River Congo is the deepest river in the world.

Vegetation

Being near the equator, the Democratic Republic of the Congo is covered by equatorial or tropical rainforests. The hot and wet climate results in very fast growth of a variety of trees. They grow to great heights in search of sunlight. The trees are so closely packed that their branches are tangled, and form a green and broad roof or canopy above. The rays of the sun cannot penetrate them easily. Therefore, the forests of the Congo Basin are dark and dim. These forests remain green throughout the year. Thus, they are also called evergreen forests.

Hardwood trees like teak, mahogany, ebony, bamboo and rosewood largely grow here. Rubber, cocoa and oil palms are the cash crops grown here. Among the native fruit trees are banana, coconut palm and plantain. Due to lack of sunlight, very little vegetation is found below the canopy of trees. Only some bushes and thick vines are seen around. These equatorial forests are so dense that it is very difficult to even pass through them.

Learn More

The Democratic Republic of the Congo has the second largest rainforests in the world after the Amazon forests.

Animal Life

Most of the animals found in the region are tree dwellers like monkeys, gorillas, chimpanzees and baboons. Other animals found in the forest region are lions, giraffes, zebras, hippopotamuses, rhinoceroses, elephants, buffaloes, leopards, hyenas and antelopes.



Elephants



Giraffes



Gorilla

Birds like hummingbirds, parrots, pelicans, flamingos, cuckoos, sunbirds, herons and plovers make this region colourful. The rivers beam with variety of fishes, dolphins and turtles, and the swampy areas with alligators and crocodiles.

Peacocks and okapis are found in large numbers in the forests of Congo. Poisonous snakes, deadly insects and flies are also found here.

Learn More

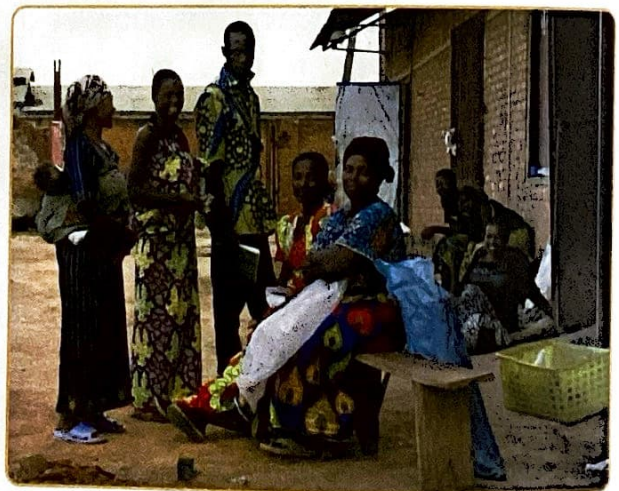
Okapis are rare relatives of giraffes that are found only in the Congo Basin.

Lifestyle of the People

The people of Congo lead a very harsh life. The hot and humid climate, dense vegetation, and the dreadful diseases caused by the insects and flies that dwell in the forest region have a great impact on the lifestyle of the people.

The country is thinly populated. The largest tribe of Congo is Bantu. People who live near the forests clear patches of forests and form small villages. They live in huts built on raised wooden platforms to protect themselves from heavy rainfall. The roofs of the houses are made of palm leaves and are thatched. The walls are made of clay. These houses do not last long because of the heavy rainfall on almost every day. The hot and damp climate also rots the wood quickly. Thus, the houses here have to be rebuilt frequently.

Due to the harsh climate, people of this region often suffer from many dreadful diseases like sleeping sickness caused by the tsetse flies, malaria, yellow fever, cholera, smallpox



People of Congo

and typhoid. People of Congo wear light cotton clothes as very often they develop rashes and irritation on their skin. Such light clothes are also suitable for hot and humid climate. Women wear long gowns, and men wear trousers and jackets.

Pygmies

Pygmies are the primitive people of the region of Congo. They live in the interior of the dense forests. They do not speak a specific language but use only signs and actions.

Pygmies lead a nomadic life, hunting and gathering berries, nuts, fruits, honey and roots. They are excellent hunters and use bows, arrows and spears for hunting. They smear mild poison at the tip of the spears and kill the animals for food. They rarely cook their food. They live in small huts made of branches of trees. They cover the huts with leaves to protect themselves from heavy rains. The pygmies are fond of dance and music.

Class Discussion

Discuss why people of Congo lead a very harsh life.



Pygmies, the primitive people of Congo

Occupation of the People

The people of Congo are engaged in fishing, hunting and gathering honey. Vegetables, maize, bananas, groundnut, and cassava or tapioca are grown here. The starchy roots of cassava are dried and made into flour to make bread. Cassava is the staple food of the people.

They clear forest areas for farming. Heavy rainfall in the region washes away the fertile top soil. Hence, they have to shift to a new piece of land. This type of farming is called shifting cultivation.

Tsetse flies cause sleeping sickness not only to the human beings but also to the animals. Hence, it is difficult to rear domestic animals here.



Cassava

The Democratic Republic of the Congo is rich in mineral deposits like copper, silver, gold, diamond, cobalt, zinc, manganese, tin, coal, uranium, petroleum and cadmium. It is the world's largest producer of cobalt. Therefore, mining is also an important occupation of the people.

Present Developments

The Democratic Republic of the Congo attained freedom in the year 1960. Since 1971, it was known as Zaire. It was renamed the Democratic Republic of the Congo in 1997. Earlier, the region was not known to many people of the world as it was very difficult to reach the country through the dense forests. Hence, the continent of Africa was called the Dark Continent by the Europeans. But now due to the advent of science and technology, and development in means of transport and communication, the country of the Democratic Republic of the Congo has become one of the developing nations of the world.

Agriculture

People work in huge farmlands outside the forests and adopt modern techniques of farming. Large forest areas are cleared and converted into agricultural lands. Cash crops like oil palm, cocoa, coffee, rubber, sugar cane and cotton are grown extensively.

Industries

The development of several cities has led to the development in industries. Textiles, chemicals, cement and paper are the main industrial products. These industries provide employment to a large number of people.

Transportation

Roads and railways are well developed in the cities. Air transport is also developing fast. However, water transport plays a major role in the transportation system. The river Congo and its tributaries serve as waterways for transportation of goods and people.

Cultural and Social Life

Tribal people of the country have their own way of worshipping Gods. Among the developed communities, Islam and Christianity are the faiths followed by people.

People are aware of the importance of education and there are schools and colleges in all major villages, towns and cities.



Democratic Republic of the Congo

Language

There are about 242 languages spoken in the Democratic Republic of the Congo. Out of these, only Kikongo, Lingala, Tshiluba and Swahili have the status of national languages. French is the official language. Bantu is the most important language of the tribal people.

Important Cities of the Region

Kinshasa, the capital city, is the largest city in the Democratic Republic of the Congo. Matadi, on the bank of river Congo, is the major port, and Lubumbashi is rich in minerals. Some other major cities of Congo are Kananga and Kisangani.

Let's Recall

- The regions located within the Tropical Zone, approximately between the latitudes of 10° north and south of the equator, are known as equatorial regions.
- River Congo and its tributaries which flow through the country have formed a low-lying area called the Congo Basin.
- The country experiences very hot and wet climate throughout the year.
- Being near the equator, the Democratic Republic of the Congo is covered by equatorial or tropical rainforests.
- The hot and humid climate, dense vegetation and dreadful diseases caused by insects and flies in the equatorial forest region have a great impact on the lifestyle of people.
- The advent of science and technology has brought about a lot of changes in the lives of the people.

Exercises

A Tick the correct answer.

1. Which of these lines of latitude passes through the Democratic Republic of the Congo?
☐ Tropic of Cancer ☐ Equator ☐ Tropic of Capricorn
2. What is the staple food of the people of the Democratic Republic of the Congo?
☐ Maize ☐ Rice ☐ Cassava
3. Which is the largest mineral produced by the Democratic Republic of the Congo?
☐ Cobalt ☐ Iron ore ☐ Crude oil
4. Which of these was called the Dark Continent?
☐ Antarctica ☐ Africa ☐ South America

B Fill in the blanks.

1. The Democratic Republic of the Congo is the second largest country in _____.
2. The capital of the Democratic Republic of the Congo is _____.
3. The Democratic Republic of the Congo became independent in the year _____.
4. The largest tribe of Congo is _____.

C Answer the following questions.

1. What is the latitudinal extent of the equatorial region?
2. Discuss the climate of the Democratic Republic of the Congo.
3. Write a short note on the Pygmies of Congo.
4. Write a short note on the recent developments in the field of agriculture in the Democratic Republic of the Congo.

D Give reasons.

1. The continent of Africa was called the dark continent by the Europeans.
2. People of the DRC wear light cotton clothes.
3. It is difficult to rear domestic animals in Congo.
4. Mining is an important occupation of the people of the Congo region.

Activities

Fun with Learning

(Observation, Critical and logical thinking)

Unscramble the letters to get the names of the countries that lie in the equatorial region.

- | | |
|---------------|-------|
| (a) ENKYA | _____ |
| (b) RABIZL | _____ |
| (c) AMALSYAI | _____ |
| (d) DOINSIANE | _____ |

9

The Desert Region

Let's Learn About

- Deserts
- Major Deserts of the World
- Location of Saudi Arabia
- Climate
- Animal Life
- Religion and Culture
- Vegetation
- Life of the People
- Language

Warm Up

Identify and name this thorny plant that grows well in a desert. You may take help of your elders or your teacher.



Deserts

Deserts cover about one-fifth of the Earth's land area. Most of them are centred along the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn. A desert can be defined as an area where there is very scanty rainfall and the vegetation is very little. It may be hot or cold but remains very dry and almost barren.

Major Deserts of the World

The larger deserts like the Sahara Desert of North Africa, the Great Basin Desert of North America, the Arabian Desert of the Arabian Peninsula, the Gobi Desert of China and the Thar Desert of India are located in the Northern Hemisphere. The Southern Hemisphere comprises the Atacama Desert of South America, the Kalahari Desert of South Africa and the Great Australian Desert of Australia.

Let's learn more about the Desert Land of Saudi Arabia in this lesson.



Major desert regions of the world

- | | | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. Great Basin Desert | 2. Peruvian Desert | 3. Atacama Desert | 4. Patagonian Desert |
| 5. Sahara Desert | 6. Arabian Desert | 7. Turkestan Desert | 8. Great Indian Desert |
| 9. Gobi Desert | 10. Kalahari and Namib Deserts | | 11. Great Australian Desert |

Location of Saudi Arabia

Saudi Arabia lies in the western part of Asia, at the junction of the continents of Europe, Asia and Africa. Some of its prominent neighbouring countries are Jordan, Iraq, Kuwait, Qatar, Yemen, Oman and Bahrain. Saudi Arabia is the largest country in West Asia, and occupies three-fourths of the Arabian Peninsula. It has the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aqaba on the west, and the Persian Gulf on the east. Most of its oil-rich regions lie in the eastern part along the Persian Gulf.

The country has the world's largest and continuous stretch of dry and sandy desert. It is known as the Rub' al Khali or the Empty Quarter. Saudi Arabia is rugged and mountainous on the western coast. Central and eastern Saudi Arabia consists of mainly plateaus and deserts. In some parts, underground water comes to the surface forming water bodies called oases. These are the only fertile parts in the desert.

Do and Learn

Which is the largest desert in the world? Find out.



Saudi Arabia and its neighbouring countries

Climate

The Tropic of Cancer passes through the centre of Saudi Arabia. Most parts of Saudi Arabia experience extreme heat and drought. It is one of the few places in the world where summer temperature rises above 50°C.

Winters are extremely cold and sometimes the temperature goes below the freezing point. There is a great difference in the day and night temperatures. In daytime, the absence of cloud cover allows the heat to penetrate through the land making the days very hot.

At night, the desert land becomes very cold. The climate remains extremely dry, and temperature fluctuates from extreme heat during day to freezing cold at night. This fluctuation in temperature makes the rocks break and crumble into tiny particles of sand. That is why most of the land surface is sandy.

Sandstorms are common in deserts. They blow away sand from place to place forming sand hills known as sand dunes. These sand dunes are not permanent and keep changing because of the sandstorms. Rainfall here is very scanty due to its distance from the sea. The dry offshore winds blowing over Saudi Arabia carry very less moisture resulting in low rainfall.



Sand dunes

Vegetation

High temperature and low rainfall have made this region very dry. The vegetation here is scattered, and consists of hard grasses, cacti, thorny bushes and shrubs. These plants are adapted to the harsh climate. The grasses have long roots that penetrate through the ground to get water, and cacti have thick and fleshy stems to hold moisture. Most of the desert plants have either very thin leaves or no leaves at all. This prevents water from evaporating from their surface. Date palms are grown in and around the oases where underground water is available and the soil is fertile.

Animal Life

Animals that live in a desert have adaptations to cope with lack of water, extreme temperatures and shortage of food. To avoid the heat, many of them burrow beneath the surface or hide in the shade during the day, emerging only at night to eat. Most desert animals are small. They do not have to drink water at all. They get all the water they need from their food. The animals found in Saudi Arabia are of different types.



Arabian Horse

Swift Runners

Gazelles, jackals and foxes move swiftly across the sandy desert to find food. Arabian horses are world famous and are known for their faithfulness and swiftness.

Burrowers

Snakes and scorpions, which cannot run fast, hide themselves under the sand during the hottest parts of the day and come out at night in search of prey.



Camel, the ship of the desert

Animals with Special Adaptation

Camel, known as the **ship of the desert**, can stay without food and water for many days. The wide padded feet of camels do not sink into the sand and help them to move across the desert without any difficulty. Their transparent and thick eyelids, and the nostrils prevent sand from getting into their eyes or nose during sandstorms. Their tongue and mouth are so rough that they can eat the thorny bushes with ease.

The water they drink is stored in their stomach and the food they eat is stored in the form of fat in their humps.

Native Animals

The native animals include ibex, wild cats, baboons, wolves and hyenas found in the mountainous highlands. Small birds like bustards pigeons and quails are found in and around the oases. Coastal areas along the Red Sea have a rich marine life consisting of flamingos and pelicans.

Life of the People

The scorching heat of the sun, severe cold weather and scarcity of water make the life of the people miserable. Sandstorms known as **simooms** that blow in summer also affect the life of the people. The people of Saudi Arabia are categorised according to their lifestyle.

Nomadic Herders

These are the nomadic people who travel from place to place in search of food and shelter for their animals. They are known as **Bedouins**. They are the natives of Saudi Arabia and speak Arabic.

They keep herds of camels, goats, sheep and horses. These animals provide them with milk, meat, hide and skin. Bedouins do not have permanent homes. They travel across the desert in groups on camels in **caravans**. They pitch temporary tents where they find pasture land for their animals.

Once the land gets dried up, they move to another place. They carry goods, which they trade, on camels. Bedouins wear long loose white cotton cloaks or gowns called **thawbs** with which they cover their whole body.



A caravan

Settled Cultivators

The people of Saudi Arabia who live in and around oases lead a settled life. They are mostly farmers and grow maize, millets, barley, wheat, cotton, sugar cane, fruits and vegetables. Date palms are the most important trees that they grow. These palm trees provide drinks and building materials they need to build their houses. These people live in villages and have wells dug for water. The wells are protected by high walls to save them from getting polluted by sand and dust. Their houses are closely built. The inner walls are covered with straw which protects them from heat. They have schools, markets and mosques in the centre of each village.

Learn More

Bedouins find their way looking at the position of the sun during the day, and the moon and prominent stars at night.

Do and Learn

Using the Internet, search and make a list of the top five oil-producing countries in the world.

City Dwellers

Saudi Arabia has rich deposits of minerals like gold, silver, copper, zinc, lead and iron. The other minerals explored in the country include crude oil, tin, chrome, nickel, titanium and precious stones. The discovery of petroleum in Saudi Arabia has changed the country drastically.

It has the largest crude oil deposits in the world and is now one of the richest countries in the world. Crude oil is known as **liquid gold** for its great economic value. When refined, it provides petrol, diesel, kerosene, aviation spirit and lubricants.

In 1937, large oil reserves were discovered near Riyadh in Saudi Arabia, and today, the country is the world's largest producer and exporter of oil.



Saudi Arabia – World's largest producer and exporter of oil

Ocean liners such as oil tankers, cargo vessels, passenger liners and fishing boats carry out trade across the large waterway, the Red Sea. The country's economy has changed the life of the people to a great extent.

Modern cities with skyscrapers and all facilities, schools, hospitals, industries, markets, well-laid roads and airports have emerged.

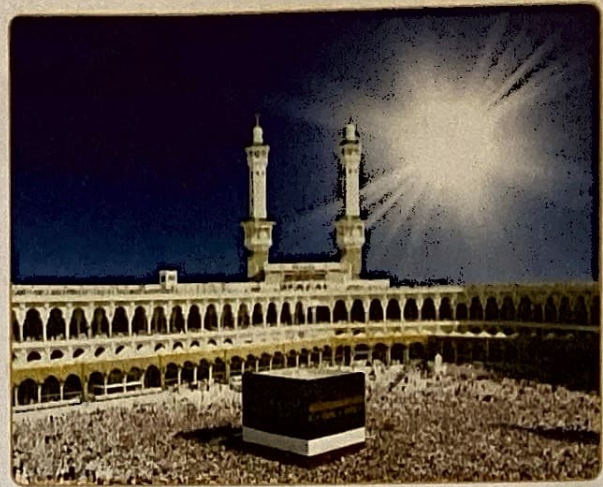
Many people from villages have settled in these cities. **Riyadh** is the capital of Saudi Arabia and its major commercial city is **Jeddah**, which is also a busy sea port. Saudi Arabia still uses much of the profits from oil exports to improve the transport and communication system of the country and the standard of living of its people.

Learn More

King Abdulaziz International Airport in Jeddah and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh are the major airports of Saudi Arabia.

Religion and Culture

Most people of Saudi Arabia follow Islam. The two most important pilgrim centres of the Muslims, **Mecca** and **Medina**, are located here. Muslims from all over the world visit these holy cities. **Al Ardha** is the country's national dance. This sword dance is based on ancient Bedouin traditions. As the men carrying swords dance, the drummers play a rhythm and the singers sing the songs.



The Kaaba, in Mecca

Language

Arabic is the main language of the people of Saudi Arabia. It is also the written language of the sacred book of Muslims, the Quran, and one of the official languages of the United Nations.

Let's Recall

- Most of the deserts are centred along the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn.
- In some parts of the desert, underground water comes to the surface forming pools of water called oases.
- The people of Saudi Arabia who live in and around oases are mostly farmers and lead a settled life.
- The vegetation here is scattered and consists of hard grasses, cacti, thorny bushes and shrubs.
- Animals that live in a desert have adaptations to cope with lack of water, extreme temperatures and shortage of food.
- Bedouins are nomadic people who travel from place to place in search of food and shelter for their animals. They are the natives of Saudi Arabia.
- The discovery of petroleum in Saudi Arabia has changed the country drastically. It is now one of the richest countries in the world.
- Arabic is the main language of the people of Saudi Arabia. It is also the written language of the sacred book of Muslims, the Quran.

Exercises

A Tick the correct answer.

- In which continent is the Arabian Desert located?
☐ South America ☐ Africa ☐ Asia
- Which of the following latitudes passes through the centre of Saudi Arabia?
☐ Tropic of Cancer ☐ Equator ☐ Tropic of Capricorn
- Which of the following minerals is found in the largest quantity in Saudi Arabia?
☐ Iron ore ☐ Crude oil ☐ Coal
- Which of the following cities is the capital of Saudi Arabia?
☐ Jeddah ☐ Riyadh ☐ Medina

B Fill in the blanks.

- The largest and continuous stretch of dry and sandy desert in Saudi Arabia is known as _____.
- Sandstorms blow away sand from place to place forming _____.
- Arabian _____ are known for their swiftness and faithfulness.
- Long loose white cotton gowns worn by the Bedouins are called _____.

C Match the columns.

- | Column A | Column B |
|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 1. The Great Basin Desert | (a) Africa |
| 2. The Great Australian Desert | (b) India |
| 3. The Gobi Desert | (c) South America |
| 4. The Atacama Desert | (d) North America |
| 5. The Thar Desert | (e) China |
| 6. The Sahara Desert | (f) Australia |

D Answer the following questions.

- Where is Saudi Arabia located?
- Name the neighbouring countries of Saudi Arabia.
- Describe the climate of Saudi Arabia.
- How has Saudi Arabia developed in such a short time?
- Write a note on the religion and culture of the people of Saudi Arabia.